

A First Look at Your Project's Size

CS 5388 / CS 4390

Team: _____ 3 _____ Project: _____ SkillUp _____

Work through every step together as a team. Have your Sprint 1 charter open (scope boundary and stakeholder map) and your interview notes. Everything you write here becomes the starting point for today's user stories and for the two estimates in Part 2.

Step 1. List what Release 1 must do *(as a team)*

Start from the “in scope” items in your charter and the strongest needs from your interviews. Write 5 to 8 capabilities as what the system must do, not how. Then mark the hidden work each one will need using the key below.

Hidden work key: T = Testing S = Security or privacy I = Integration with other systems D = Data (collection, cleaning, migration) H = Hosting and deployment U = Usability and accessibility O = Documentation or training

#	Capability (what, not how)	Evidence (charter or interview)	Hidden work
1	A user can record recreational activities they have completed	Project Charter, Interview 2 in Phase 2	T, S, D, U
2	A user can track their progress across recreational activities through a personalized portfolio.	Project Charter, Interview 2 in Phase 1	T, S, D, U
3	A user can find resources that can help them start or improve in a recreational activity	Project Charter, Interview 5 in Phase 2	S, I, D, U
4	Instructors can create lessons and provide resources for recreational activities	Project Charter	T, S, D, U, O
5	A user can connect with other users based on shared recreational activities.	Project Charter, Interview 8 in Phase 2	T, S, I, D, U
6	A user can find an instructor and request to book a lesson	Project Charter, Interview 4 in Phase 2	T, S, I, D, U
7	A user can discover recreational activities and events.	Project Charter, Interview 4 in Phase 2	T, S, I, D, U
8	A user can set personalized goals for their recreational activities and track progress toward them..	Project Charter, Interview 4 in Phase 1	T, S, D, U

Step 2. Take the outside view: your own experience *(as a team)*

As a team, pick the most similar thing any of you has built before: a class project, internship feature, hackathon app, or side project.

Question	Answer
What was it?	A journal/mood tracker mobile app.
How long was it expected to take?	It was expected to take about 2 weeks.
How long did it take?	It took the full 2 weeks.

Question	Answer
What took longer than expected?	Figuring out how modal views and sheets work in SwiftUI.

Step 3. Take the outside view: similar products *(as a team, web search)*

Divide the searching, then decide together. Find three real products that solve a problem close to yours. Include at least one small product (a startup or an app from a small team) and at least one big product (a large company platform or a government system). For each, find out how long it took to reach its first public release, what went well, and what went wrong.

How to find the timeline and the story

1. Launch announcements, company blogs, and founder interviews often say when building started and when the product first went public.
2. Press coverage, app store version histories, and the Internet Archive's Wayback Machine help confirm first release dates.
3. Postmortems, conference talks, and, for government systems, GAO and Inspector General reports explain what worked and what did not.
4. Measure from the start of development to the first public release, and write down what that first release included. A limited first version and a full launch are different numbers.
5. Every date and figure needs a source you can link. If you cannot find one, write "unknown." AI tools may suggest products to look at, but they are not a source.

Step 3 worksheet: similar products

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (your choice)
Product and company	Everyday.app	Skill Share	Strava, Inc
Why it is similar to your project	Everyday.app and SkillUp allow users to track their activities, establish personal goals and monitor their progress. Everyday seems to focus more on habits rather than recreational activities and does not offer any resources.	This product offers learning resources with a paywall, while ours offers them for free or through instructors.	Strava and SkillUp allow users to record recreational activities, track personal progress, set goals, and connect with people with similar interests. Strava focuses primarily on physical activities, while SkillUp expands to many more recreational activities.
Development started	Development started early 2017.	Skill Share started development in November 2010.	Development started between 2007-2008.
First public release	It became publicly available in March 2017.	Skill Share's online platform launched in April of 2011.	Strava early beta version opened in May 2009.
Time to first release	It took approximately 3 weeks to develop the first working version. But unconfirmed development to first release.	Time period between development and launch is roughly 6 months.	Approximately 1-2 years.
What the first release included	Habit tracker that allowed users to record daily habits and see their progress on a board.	The site included only offline courses, which only connected users to local classes near them. Did not allow users to take courses online with	First release focuses on cycling and had a website where users could upload GPS activity data, track their performance, and compare results with other cyclists.

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (your choice)
		video calls or plain video lectures.	
Team size, if known	One developer	There were 2 co-founding members when development started.	There were 6 founding members.
What worked	The developer focused on essential features and kept application simple. This allowed him to create first working version in 3 weeks. He also shared the app online which helped receive feedback.	Testing their concept early using a strategy called Minimum Viable Product, where they sold classes through an event hosting site to see if people would actually buy into it.	Testing early prototype with cycling leaderboards and testing with small groups of athletes.
What did not work	After being shared on reddit the server struggled to handle the increase in traffic.	Their initial launch did not originally have their online courses; they allowed users to enroll in local sessions through the website. This did not work due to scaling issues and market reach. Users had to be in	Founders had the idea in the 1990s, but available technology was insufficient. GPS were uncommon, and smartphones did not exist. These limitations delayed the development of Strava.

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (your choice)
		specific geological locations to attend the courses, while instructors had to find locations for the class to be in.	
Sources (links)	https://everyday.app/ https://everyday.app/blog/everydaycheck-interview-on-indiehackers/	Website itself (SkillShare), News article from (Article). Techcrunch Article (Article), Fox Business (Article), Harvard Platform (Article), Mixergy (Article)	https://research.contrary.com/company/strava

Step 4. Compare *(as a team)*

1. Look at the hidden-work column in Step 1. Which letter appears most often? Did any of your similar products struggle with that same kind of work?

The most often letters are S, D, and U

The ones that appear similar are Steps 1, 2, and 8 with T, S, D, and U.

Others that appear similar are Steps 5, 6, and 7 with T, S, I, D, and U

2. How long did your similar products take to reach a first release, and with how many people? What does that suggest about the first release of your project?

The simpler similar product, Everyday.app, took about three weeks to reach its first release and was developed by one person. The next product, Skillshare, took about six months to reach its first release and was initially developed by two people. The last product, Strava, took approximately one to two years to reach its first release and was founded by six members. This suggests that based on the complexity and planned features of our project, it would be beneficial to release an MVP and focus on the most important features.

3. Name one practice from the “what worked” rows your team will copy, and one mistake from the “what did not work” rows you will avoid.

The thing that worked was Practice A where they focused on the essential features and application for the app that was able to launch in 3 weeks and what not worked was Practice A after sharing it on Reddit the server struggled to hand the amount of increased traffic

Our comparables suggest a first release would take __6__ to __12__ months with a team of __5__.

Keep this sheet. You will use Step 1 to write user stories, and Steps 2 and 3 give you comparators for analogous estimation in Part 2.